68. As founder and president of the children's defense fund, Marian Wright Edelman has ensured that, even though the young cannot vote or make campaign contributions, they are nevertheless not _____ in Washington.

A. welcome
B. ignored
C. committed
D. represented

Clues: Eventhough children cannot influence affairs in the usual ways, thanks of Edelman's work they are nevertheless not **ignored**. **Answer: B**

69. With mounting excitement, modern scientists were able to train sophisticated instruments on an exploding star and analyze in detail a phenomenon _____ to the structure of the universe, to the formation of the starts, and indeed to life itself.

A. fundamental
B. tangential
C. irrelevant
D. comparable

Clues: The scientists are pleased to discover something **fundamental** (=basic and important) to the structure of the universe, the starts, and even life. **Answer: A**

70. The satellite moved _____ through space; it hadn't been blasted into its proper orbit.

A. routinely
B. dynamically
C. eccentrically
D. gradually

Clues: The satellite is off-course and is moving **eccentrically** (=peculiarly or irregularly) though space. **Answer: C**

71. The physicians were worried about the possibility of finding growth in the patient.

A. a malignant
B. a benign
C. an operable
D. an enigmatic

Clues: If the physiciants are worried, the growth must be **malignant** or harmful. **Answer: A**

72. Rather than judge his characters in a narrowly moralistic sense, updike instead _____ their frailties, foibles, and earnest attempts at self-knowledge with authority and compassion, letting the reader _____ the judging.

A. obscures…suffer
B. exposes…do
C. condemns…enjoy
D. disregards…forgo

Clues: Updike carefully **exposes (=shows)** good and bad things about his characters, instead of simply starting standard judgments about them,, so that the reader can **do** the judging.

Answer: B

73. While the disease is in _____ state, it is almost impossible to determine its existence by _____.

A. an acute …analysis
B. a suspended…estimate
C. a latent… observation
D. a critical….examination

Clues: **Latent:** existing but not yet active, developed or visible; existing or present but concealed or inactive **(latent = dormant)**.

→ dormant thing can't be simply determined by **observation.**

Answer: C

74. In Science, _____ it only a conjecture until it is proven or disproved by _____ experimentation.

A. a hypothesis….rigorous
B. a prediction…contrive
C. an abstraction…curiosity
D. a theory…public

Clues: In the first sentence **conjecture** is a statement or an idea which is **unproven**, but is thought to be true, agues: A supposition based upon incomplete evidence; a **hypothesis**.

Rigorous – strictly accurate or detailed.

Answer: A

75. His unabridged curiosity lets explore every field _____ yet his _____ stances kept him at odds with the devout society he so wanted to be acknowledged by

A. science…interesting
B. interest…common
C. thought…unorthodox
D. study…optimistic

Clues: **unorthodox** – being different from what is usual traditional or acceptable.

Answer: C

76. His employers could not complain about his work because he was _____ in the _____ of his duties.

A. meticulous…postponement
B. hidbound…conception
C. derelict…performance
D. assiduous…execution

Clues: Why wouldn't his employers complain about his work?
Because he was **assiduous** in the **execution** of his duties.
→ **assiduous** – working hard and showing careful attention
→ **execution**: the action of doing a piece of work, performing a duty or putting a plan, design into effect.

Answer: A

77. Created to serve as perfectly as possible their work day ____ the wooden storage boxes made in some communities are now _____ for their beauty.

A. function…valid
B. environment … accepted
C. owners…employed
D. image…seen

Clues: The wooden storage boxes made in Somali communities besides their workday /day to day function, they are valued for their beauty.

Answer: A

78. Some students are _____ and want to take only the courses for which they see immediate value.

A. pragmatic
B. opinionated
C. impartial
D. idealistic

Clues: **pragmatic** (is the opposite of **idealistic**) (=Solving problems in a practical and sensible way rather than by having fixed ideas or theories.
→ **pragmatic = realistic.**

Answer: A

79. The young graduated was quickly promoted when his boss saw how _____ he was.

A. tired B. hasty C. destitute D. diligent

Clues: Why was the young graduate quickly promoted? Because he was been **diligent (=hardworking).**

Answer: D

80. Most people attempt to present a particular image of themselves to others; they also _____ a lot of time and energy in developing such an image.

A. want B. ration C. loss D. invest

Clues: If you **invest** time or energy in something, you spend a lot of time or energy on something that you consider to be useful or likely to be successful.

Answer: D

81. Ever since I arrived at the school last Thursday, I've been _ by the rude behavior of the students. In contrast, the teachers were _____.

A. shocked…surprised
B. stunned…indifferent
C. surprised…flabbergasted
D. neutral…dispassionate

Clues: The rude behavior of someone always makes someone **shocked, upset, annoyed.** The phrase **"in contrast"** tells us the two opposite ideas.

Answer: A

82. Given the ability of modern technology to destroy the environment, it is clear that if we are not careful, the race of man may soon be as _____ as the dinosaur.

A. negligent
B. fallible
C. extinct
D. intelligent

Clues: Destruction of the environment could lead humanity to die out or become **extinct**.

Answer: C

83. The Americans and the British seem to have a dog-in-the-manager attitude towards the island of Malta, no longer needing it themselves but nevertheless wishing to _____ it to others.

A. deny B. praise C. reveal D. offer

Clues: To **deny** or refuse to others something you yourself don't need or want is to behave like the proverbial dog-in-the-manger, who didn't want the hay in the manger but refused to let the hungry cattle get at it.

Answer: A

84. The new company's gravest problem, one that mars the current production, is a desire for correctness and technical accuracy that _____ both energy and musical response.

A. reflects
B. enhances
C. stifles
D. supplies

Clues: An overemphasis on correctness that **stifled** or represse the performers liveliness would mar or spoil a production.

Answer:

85. Egocentric, at times inductive when he believed his authority wa being questioned, white could also be find, gracious, and even _____ when the circumstances seemed to require it.

A. disdainful
B. nonchalantly
C. self-deprecating
D. provocative

Clues: Despite his self-centeredness, white could be kind to others and even belittle himself (**be self-deprecating**).
- Something **concise** is brief in **length**.

Answer: C

86. Instead of taking exaggerated precautions against touching o tipping or jarring the bottle of wine, only to use a napkin keep he hands from the cool bottle itself.

A. nonchalantly
B. ambivalently
C. tentatively
D. reverently

Clues: The waitress handled the bottle **nonchalantly** or casually, without undue excitement.

Answer: A

87. Biologist categorize many of world's environments as deserts regions where the _____ availability of some key factor, such as water, sunlight or an essential nutrient, places sharp constraints on the existence of living things.

A. gradual
B. limited
C. ready
D. nearby

Clues: A **limited** unavailability of necessities would pu constraints or restrictions on the creatures needing them.

Answer: B

88. According to Lionel Trilling, the paradox of liberalism was that in its quest for freedom it must move toward organization, legislation, and _____

A. levity
B. anarchy
C. control
D. stagnation

Clues: It is a paradox that, in order to gain freedom, one must move toward freedom's opposite, **control**.

Answer: C

89. This psychological biography presents a picture of a deeply individual, unable to _____ anyone else's success. whose ruthless pursuit of recognition and fame has been marked by hypocritical gestures of openness and affection.

A. indolent…vilify
B. apathetic…match
C. egotistical…tolerate
D. modest…admit

Clues: An **egotistical** or self-centrered and conceited person would find it difficult to **tolerate** or bear someone else's success.

Answer: C

90. Stop reporting to _____; make a direct charge or drop the matter.

A. innuendo
B. criticism
C. slander
D. subterfuge

Clues: An **innuendo** is an indirect hint.

Answer: A

91. During the middle of the eighteen century, the _____ style in furniture and architect true, marked by scroll work and excessive decoration, flourished.

A. medieval
B. rococo
C. artistic
D. gothic

Clues: The architectural style marked by excessive decoration is called the **rococo**.

Answer: B

92. I am afraid that this order raid is the _____ of more serious attacks.

A. reply B. harbinger C. antidote D. successor

Clues: **Harbinger** conveys the meaning of forerunner or introducer.

Answer: B

93. Since all the financial news is so gloomy, I do not understand how you can have such _____ view about the future of the stock market.

A. a roseate
B. a skeptical
C. a negative
D. a melancholy

Clues: **Roseate** means optimistic or promising.

Answer: A

94. Aristotle maintained that tragedy created a _____ by purging the soul of base concepts.

A. paradox
B. vacuum
C. catharsis
D. problem

Clues: Purging the soul of base concepts is called **catharsis**.

Answer:

95. Since you disagree with Tade's arguments in this dispute, your _____ of his position is _____

A. endorsement…logical
B. disapproval…unexpected
C. support…hypocritical
D. approval…understandable.

Clues: If a person **supports** a positions with which he disagrees his behavior may be described as **hypocritical**.

Answer:

96. The dinner has been arranged to honor the _____ of Mr. Daniel whose act of philanthropy have helped many needy individuals.

A. altruism
B. prodigality
C. diversity
D. tenacity

Clues: **Altruism** means unselfishness. **Prodigality** (choice B) means extravagance. We honor generosity rather than extravagance.

Answer:

97. Samor was awarded the medal of Honor in recognition of his _____ in the very fierce battle.

A. attitude
B. fortitude
C. garrulity
D. accuracy

Clues: **Fortitude** means **courage**.

Answer:

98. It was a great victory, but its _____ effect will not be _____ until we learn exactly how badly the enemy fared.

A. finite…apprehended
B. real…appreciated
C. lasting…implemented
D. long-time…felt

Clues: (Choice C) is the best of the lot. **Appreciate** as used in this sentence means become fully aware of.

Answer:

99. Few in the audience waited for the _____; they had found the performance amateurish and boring.

A. overture
B. dialog
C. curtain
D. epilogue

Clues: An **epilogue** is a speech delivered at the end of a play.

Answer: D

100. We find it hard to believe that there is no _____ between the resignation of the company.

A. competition
B. cohesion
C. condescension
D. connection

Clues: **Connection** indicates a causal relation; the implication is that the treasure's resignation and the missing funds are related.

Answer: D

101. Because his time was limited, Thomas decided to read the _____ novel War and Peace in _____ edition.

A. wordy…an unedited
B. lengthy…an abridged autographed
C. famous… a modern
D. romantic…an

Hint: Time limitations would cause problems for you if you were reading a **lengthy** book. To save time, you might want to read it in an **abridged** or shortened form.

(So, it is about **cause and effect signal)**

Answer: B

102. Although gregarious by nature, Bety became quiet and ____ after she was unexpectedly laid off from work.

A. autonomous
B. susceptible
C. assertive
D. withdrawn

Hint: Bety was normally gregarious or sociable. When she unexptedly lost her job, she became quiet and withdrawn **(distant; unsociable)**.

(The relationship is about **contrast pattern)**

Answer: D

103. In giving speech, the speaker's goal is to communicate ide clearly and _____, so that the audience well be in no ___ about the meaning of the speech.

A. effectively...hates
B. indirectly...distress
C. vigorously...discomfort
D. unambiguously...confusion

Hint: Speakers wish to communicate unambiguously in orde that there may be no **confusion** about their meaning.

Note: Remember to watch for signal words that link one part o the sentence to another. The precence of 'and' linking two items in a series indicates that the missing word may be a synonym or near synonym for the other linked word. In this case, **unambiguously** in a synonym for **clearly**. Similarly, the use 'so that' in the second clause signa cause and effect. **[Argument pattern]** **Answer: D**

104. Medieval kingdom didn't become constitutional republic overnight; on the contrary, the change was _____.

A. unpopular
B. gradual
C. advantageous
D. sufficient

Clue: The phrase 'on the contrary' is your key to the correct answer. It is what we call a signal word. It signals a contrast. On the contrary sets up contrast between a hypothetical change and actual change. **Answer: B**

105. He felt that the uninspiring routine of office work was too _ for someone of his talent and creativity.

A. diverse
B. gradual
C. exacting
D. insatiable

Hint: The subject considers himself talented and creative and thinks office work is inspiring, dull, in a word **prosaic.**

Note: the missing word must be a synonym or near synonym. for "uninspiring." Connected by the linking word '**was**', both words describe or define the office routine.

Answer: B [definition]

106. The museum arranged the fossils in _____ order, placing the older fossils dating from the late Ice Age on the first floor and the more recent fossils on the second floor.

A. alphabetical
B. random
C. chronological
D. arbitrary

Clue: A **chronological** order is one arranged in order of time. The missing word is an adjective describing the order in which the museum arranged the fossils. The second part of the sentence defines that order: from older to more recent in time. **Cron** means time.

Answer: C [definition]

107. With the evolution wings, insects were able to _____ to the far ecological corners, across deserts and bodies of water, to reach new food sources and inhabit a wider variety of promising environmental inches.

A. disperse
B. relate
C. transgress
D. revert

Clue: Thanks to the development of wings, insects were able to **disperse** or scatter over the earth's surface. Thus, they were able to reach new habitats and untapped sources of nourishment. **[Cause and effect pattern].** **Answer: A**

108. What most _____ the magazines critics is the manner in which its editorial opinions are expressed – too often as if only an idiot could see things any other way.

A. riles B. impedes C. belies D. identifies

Clue: The critics are **relied** or irritated by the condescending, superior to one of the magazine's editorials.

Note how the section of the sentence following the hyphen illustrates what aspect of the magazine annoys its critics.

Answer: A

109. While the 1940s are most noted for the development of black modern dance, they are also _____ because they were the last gasp for tap dancing.

A. irrelevant
B. unfounded
C. significant
D. contemporary

Clue: **"While"** suggests a contrast between the fates of the two dance forms during the 1940s. The decade was **most** noted for the growth of Black modern dance. However, it was

also noteworthy or **significant** for the decline of t
dancing. **[contrast signal]**. **Answer: C**

110. People who take megadoses of vitamins and minerals should tak
care : though beneficial in small quantities, in large amounts thes
substances may have _____ effects.

A. admirable
B. redundant
C. intangible
D. toxic

Clue: Something beneficial or helpful in small amounts may b
toxic (poisonous) in large amounts.
Remember to watch for signal words that link one part o
the sentence to another. The use of "though" in the secon
clause sets up a contrast. The missing word must be a
antonym or near-antonym for beneficial. **[Argumen**
pattern] **Answer: D**

111. Although Brian's film makers often produce fine films, they are
studiously _____ and rarely aim at a mass market.

A. elitist
B. collaborative
C. viable
D. derivative

Clue: To aim at a mass market is to try to appeal to the lowes
common denominator. British films rarely do this. Instead
of trying to appeal to the masses, they try to appeal to elite
They are thus **elitist. [contrast signal]** **Answer: A**

Review Exercise

1. I'll attempt to _____ you of your impression of my client's guilt; I know he is _____ .

A. disabuse…innocent
B. limit…invincible
C. free…culpable
D. relieve…guiltless

2. This salesman is guilty of _____ in describing his product; it is wise to discount his claims.

A. hyperbole
B. chicanery
C. hypocrisy
D. altruism

3. What we consider a luxury at one time frequently becomes a _____; many families find that ownerships of two cars is _____.

A. nuisance…mandatory
D. fad…ridiculous

B. need...undesirable
C. trend...fashionable
E. necessity...indispensable

4. In a revolutionary development in technology, several manufactures now make biodegradable forms of plastic; some plastic six pack rings, for example, gradually _____ when exposed to sunlight.

A. decompose
B. harden
C. inflate
D. stagnate

5. Our _____ in this matter may prove disastrous; we must move to aid our alliance immediately.

A. pacifism B. inertia C. attitude D. enervation

6. In thinking only of your present needs and ignoring the future, you are being rather _____.

A. callous B. myopic C. brave D. indifferent

7. She is a pragmatist, as _____ to base her future on impractical dreams as she would be to build a castle on shifting sand.

A. quick
B. diligent
C. disinclined
D. determined

8. Where we consider a luxury at one time frequenclty becomes a _____; many families find that ownership of two cars is _____.

A. necessity...indispensable
B. fed...ridiculous
C. trend....fashionable
D. nuisance...mandatory

9. Even though he remained silent, his _____ indicated his displeasure

A. sight B. huzzahs C. grimaces D. comments

10. In primitive times, poetry was written to be heard; today, we frequently overlook the _____ nature of the poet's.

A. oral B. actual C. verbal D. stylistic

11. We were unable to reach a decision because we felt that the speaker had been _____ and had avoided many of our questions.
A. prolix
B. noncommittal
C. candid
D. unprepared

12. In these interfaith meetings, there must be no attempt to _____; we must respect all points of view
A. proselytize
B. pray
C. disagree
D. control

13. The _____ attached to this job make it even more attractive than the salary indicates.
A. accessories
B. prerequisites
C. conditions
D. perquisites

14. Although I don't wish to _____ your contribution, I feel we must place it in its proper perspective.
A. negate
B. bewail
C. belittle
D. analyze

15. The country is gradually losing its _____ occupation and turning more and more to an industrial point of view.
A. agrarian
B. philosophic
C. mechanical
D. altruistic

16. We lost confidence in him because he never _____ the grandiose promises he had made.
A. forgot about
B. retreated from
C. delivered on
D. tired of

17. The _____ of both parties in the dispute makes an early settlement almost impossible to obtain.
A. reluctance
B. intransigence
C. acumen
D. intolerance

18. His _____ handling of the difficult situation earned him the praise of all present; all commented on his skillful performance.
A. affable
B. brusque
C. gauche
D. adroit

19. It is impossible to obtain their _____ to the proposal because it is _____ to their philosophy.
A. acquiescence...abhorrent

B. avowal...pertinent
C. opposition...repugnant
D. compliance...alien

20. The _____ qualities of his poetry overshadow its literary qualities; the lesson he teaches is more memorable than the lines.
A. prosaic
B. poetic
C. metaphoric
D. didactic

21. Measurement is, like any other human endeavor, a complex activity, subject to error, not always used _____ ,and frequently misinterpreted and _____.
A. systematically...organized
B. innovatively...refined
C. properly...misunderstood
D. mistakenly...derided

22. This should _____ the pain; if it does not, we shall have to use stronger drugs.
A. instigate
B. alleviate
C. destroy
D. dilute

23. Even though your statement doesn't declare that you are at war with that country, the actions of your country _____ that is the actual situation.
A. interdict B. imply C. depict D. simulate

24. It is not our aim to _____ our foes; we are interested only in establishing amicable relations by _____ means.
A. conquer...martial
B. subjugate...peaceful
C. oppress...illicit
D. dominate...halcyon

25. Eventhough your argument is _____ I still would like to have more proof.
A. plausible
B. dubious
C. integrated
D. fallacious

26. She is very _____ and can speak on the telephone for hours.
A. pertinent
B. brusque
C. loquacious
D. flighty

27. In one instance of _____ research, one of the nation's most influential geneticists reported on experiments that we never carried out and published deliberately _____ scientific papers on his nonexistent work.
A. comprehensive...abstract
B. derivative...authoritative
C. erroneous...impartial
D. fraudulent...deceptive

28. The rebels sought to overcome the _____ of strength of the government forces by engaging in guerrilla tactics.
A. preponderance
B. predilection
C. lack
D. accumulation

29. He was afraid of call "a spade a spade," and resorted to ___ to avoid direct reference to his subject.
A. allegory
B. minority...new
C. allusions
D. subterfuge

30. The _____ feared mob rule and gave the right to vote only to the wealthy, thus depriving the _____ of a voice in government.
A. leaders...followers
B. minority...new
C. aristocracy...proletarians
D. aristocracy...elite

31. He was not _____ and proffered to be alone most of the time.
A. gregarious
B. patient
C. gracious
D. isolated

32. The native took advantage of the _____; they used every chasm, gorge, and mountain in the area as hiding places from which they launched their attacks.
A. cartography
B. calligraphy
C. geology
D. topography

33. In order to _____ a sudden outbreak of hostilities, we must give our toe no _____
A. prevent...provocation
B. effect ...instigation
C. insure...excuse
D. control...permission

34. The _____ of the conquerors knew no bounds they demanded more and more tribute from the defeated people.
A. impotence
C. politeness

B. culpability D. avarice

That which is _____ is _____

35. A. unfeigned…genuine C. feigned…genuine
B. fictional…loquacious D. fictional…veracious

We must _____ those whom we send to prison.

36. A. observe C. punish
B. rehabilitate D. incarcerate

We must always remember not to _____ anyone's

37. contribution; even little gifts and up to large sums.
A. disparage C. discuss
B. tolerate D. disseminate

All attempts to _____ the character of our late president

38. have failed; the people still _____ him.
A. rescue…respect C. denigrate…love
B. evaluate…support D. desecrate…abhor

In that youthful movement, the leaders were only a little less

39. than their _____ followers.
A. adolescent…venerable C. callow…immature
B. inert…lethargic D. juvenile…adult

Although he was not _____, he was _____ in his

40. purchase of small luxuries.
A. frugal…prodigal C.
extravagant…improvident
B. lavish…deliberate D. thrifty…wasteful

The Gallup poll reveals that most people are for or against the

41. _____; few are _____.
A. candidate…undecided C. legislation…affected
B. affirmative…negative D. suggestion…positive

It was unprepared for the state of _____ in which I had

42. found my old friend; he seemed to have aged twenty years in six
months.
A. euphoria C. depletion
B. decrepitude D. uncertainty

43. Since this meeting had been planned by the participants, we cannot call it a _____ occurrence.

A. flagrant
B. fortuitous
C. calamitous
D. limited

44. This island is a colony; however, in most matters, it is _____ and receives no orders from the mother country.

A. aloof
B. submissive
C. autonomous
D. distant

45. Though he insisted that his conscience was clear and that he had done nothing _____, lawyers said that he might face as many as five criminal counts.

A. tentative
B. illegal
C. hypothetical
D. justifiable

46. Although I find his observations very _____, his _____ speeches often alienate his audiences rather than convince.

A. opposite...pithy
B. startling...realistic
C. annoying...pompous
D. cogent...bombastic

47. The judge agreed that the witness's remarks were not _____ to the issue being discussed and ordered them stricken from the record.

A. impertinent
B. consistent
C. germane
D. factual

48. His repeated promises of reform did not assuage, but _____ her, for she well knew from past failures how small a likelihood there was that he would change.

A. enraged
B. mollified
C. gratified
D. reassured

49. To avoid _____. I am going to ask all of you to repeat the instructions I have given.

A. misconstruction
B. clarity
C. insecurity
D. disavowal

50. In these _____ times, we must be especially alert t offset the work of saboteurs and propagandists.

A. precocious
B. literate
C. precarious
D. protective

51. If I _____ to this demand for blackmail. I am afraid that I will be the victim of future demands.
A. relate B. accede C. succumb D. conform

52. The book should be the _____ work on the subject unless new discoveries make revision _____.
A. major…meaningful C. best…obsolete
B. definitive…necessary D. ultimate…plausible

53. Her _____ made her seem superior to the chattering schoolgirls.
A. youth C. reticence
B. volubility D. nonsense

54. Although the _____ was not prolonged, it was violent enough to _____ in a nasty bruise for Yonas.
A. debate…end C. visit…conclude
B. alteraction…result D. squabble…delight

55. Before criticizing the work of an artist, one needs to _____ his purpose.
A. reveal B. discern C. correct D. transform

56. Despite his _____ defense of the castle, defeat was imminent.
A. villainous C. valorous
B. tentative D. vapid

57. Her reaction to his proposal was _____ she rejected it _____.
A. sympathetic…angrily C. violent…vehemently
B. clever…obtusely D. subtle…forthrightly

58. She was _____ because her plans had gone _____
A. distraught…awry C. pleased…astray
B. foiled…well D. imminent…amiss

59. The newspaper reporter threatened to _____ the city official's illegal dealings unless he resigned immediately.
A. hide B. condone C. expose D. excuse

60. Although there are _____ outbursts of gunfire, we any report that the major rebellion has been suppressed.
A. sporadic B. bitter C. meager D. heinous

61. Mankind needs a _____ dream, an ideal _____ by the poet; without this, life is meaningless.
A. futile...ridiculed
B. powerful...enervated
C. visionary...created
D. pathetic...caused

62. An individual who is _____ is incapable of _____
A. modest...shame
B. fettered...flight
C. militant...fear
D. ambitious...failure

63. Your _____ attitude will alienate any supporter your may have won to your causes.
A. truculent
B. tortuous
C. fascinating
D. logical

64. The sugar dissolved in water _____; finally all that remained was an almost _____ residue on the bottom of the glass.
A. subsequently...glassy
B. spectacularly...opaque
C. quickly...lumpy
D. gradually...imperceptible

65. We were sure he had prepared some _____ to defeat us, but he was defeated by our _____.
A. contrivance...promise
B. element...leniency
C. plot...contraption
D. stratagem...ruse

66. The heavy meal and the overheated room made us all _____.
A. belligerent
B. noisy
C. somnolent
D. pacific

67. Because his occupation required that he work at night and sleep during the day, he had an exceptionally _____ complexion.
A. pallid B. plain C. ruddy D. smooth

68. Many civil leaders are waging a constant battle against the _____ billboards that dot our countryside.
A. ubiquitous
B. omniscient
C. desultory
D. wooden

69. Man is essentially a _____ animal and tends to ____ others.
A. selfish...resent
B. vicarious...examine
C. perverse...adopt
D. gregarious...work with

Unless you train your body you cannot be an athlete and unless you train your _____ you can't be a _____

A. spirit...logician B. courage...hero

I did not anticipate reading such _____ discussion of the international situation in the morning news paper; normally, such a treatment could be found found only in scholar magazines.

A. overt B. erudite C. arrogant D. analytical

We were certain that disaster was _____

A. immutable
B. imminent
C. inherent
D. invidious

If we _____ these experienced people to position of unimportant because of their political persuasions, we shall lose the service of valuably trained personnel.

A. condemn B. repress C. banish D. relegate

Some students are _____ and want to take only the courses for which they see immediate value.

A. impartial
B. idealistic
C. theoretical
D. pragmatic

To be _____ is to be easily _____

A. malleable...shaped
B. placated...nettled
C. gullible...believed
D. credulous...involved

Archeological work on the newly-discovered site exposed some fascinating _____ from the ancient city.

A. artifacts B. legends C. anecdotes D. novelties

For _____ conduct under difficult conditions, he was awarded a medal.

A. executive B. veracious C. exemplary D. notorious

When the infant displayed signs of illness, the anxious parents called in a _____.

A. periodonist
B. plagiarist
C. pediatrician
D. podiatrist

79. Because this liquid is highly _____, it should be kept in a tightly corked bottle lest it evaporated.
A. voluble
B. volatile
C. explosive
D. expensive

80. Because _____ is such a _____ disease, its victims historically where shunned by healthy people.
A. poverty...social
B. cancer...malignant
C. leprosy...loathsome
D. halitosis...offensive

81. A _____ person is not noted for _____ practices
A. prodigal...thrifty
B. laconic...taciturn
C. wanton...sane
D. wealthy...affluent

82. I fail to understand why there is such a _____ atmosphere; we have lost a battle.
A. giddy B. murky C. blatant D. funereal

83. When I listened to her cogent arguments, all my _____ were and I was forced to agree with her point of view.
A. doubts...dispelled
B. questions...asked
C. friends...present
D. senses...stimulated

84. After the accident, he was so _____ that he was unable to work and was forced to retire.
A. incapacitated
B. alleviated
C. immutable
D. embellished

85. The young man was quickly promoted when his employers saw how _____ he was.
A. negligent
B. indigent
C. industrious
D. lethargic

86. He interpreted the departure of the birds as an _____ of evil.
A. augury B. action C. indication D. aspect

87. Since he could not reclaim his inheritance by _____ means, he was forced to _____ to the methods of his underworld friends.
A. violent...turn
B. legal...vindicate
C. legitimate...resort
D. foul...switch

88. He was _____ because he was always _____

A. abnoxious...rude
B. irritable...rude
C. pleasant...importunate

89. As mayor, she displayed such a clear and _____ mind in solving the city's complex problems that she was elected to the post for a second term.
A. democratic
B. regulated
C. logical
D. social

90. We weren't _____; we merely retired a more advantageous position.
A. victorious
B. animated
C. vanquished
D. hostile

91. He acted on impulse and didn't _____ the possible consequences.
A. contravene
B. awaken
C. ruminate
D. remonstrate

92. Given the current financial crisis, there'll be no further government _____ on any programs of this kind, at least for the _____ future.
A. expenditures...foreseeable
B. action...inevitable
C. cutbacks...near
D. disclosures...recent

93. I grew more and more aware of Bruk's _____ purpose as I watched him carefully plant the seeds of suspicion in Haile's mind.
A. malevolent
B. generous
C. noble
D. negligible

94. To the dismay of the student body, the class president was _____ berated by the principal at a school assembly.
A. nobly
B. privately
C. privately
D. ignominiously

95. Although had received great _____ the judge ruled that in striking the first blow he was the aggressor.

A. vindication
B. alleviation
C. provocation
D. acclaim

96. This unexpected _____ shown by the usually obdurate judge overwhelmed the prisoner, who burst into tears of gratitude.
A. magnanimity
B. gravity
C. rebuttal
D. opinion

97. The insurance company claimed that it was not _____ for damages caused by an act of God.
A. liable
B. culpable
C. indulgent
D. credulous

98. The teacher _____ himself between the fighting youths.
A. solidified
B. provoked
C. involved
D. interposed

99. They were aware of the _____ of the situations; nevertheless, they _____ according to plan.
A. urgency…accelerated
B. gravity…proceeded
C. climax…ended
D. humor…laughed

100. the child was so spoiled by her indulgent parents that she pouted and became _____ when she did not receive all of their attention.
A. sullen
B. elated
C. discreet
D. suspicious

101. She always tries to look at the bright side of every situation; her friends call her _____.
A. a zealot
B. opportunist
C. an antagonist
D. an optimist

102. The gift was so _____ that the bridge was over whelmed by its unexpectedly large amount.
A. negligible
B. parsimonious
C. munificent
D. nostalgic

103. The reasoning in this editorial is so _____ that we cannot see how anyone can be deceived by it.
A. coherent
C. unconscious

B. dispassionate
D. astute

104. Despite his _____ appearance, she recognized an inherent grace in his movements as he walked about the room.
A. gallant
B. ungainly
C. unconscious
D. noble

105. Starting out the window while the lecturer droned on the bored student _____ the teachers instructions.
A. heeded
B. protested
C. defended
D. ignored

106. In the interest of reducing diplomatic tensions in that part of the world, the United Nations General Assembly _____ in the between the two nations.
A. intervened…dispute
B. inquired…security
C. interrupted…battle
D. intercepted…war

107. His _____ directions missed us; we inevitably took the wrong turn in the road.
A. ambivalent
B. exemplary
C. ambiguous
D. thorough

108. Impressed by the accuracy of her previous predictions, the girl left that she was _____.
A. clairvoyant
B. haunted
C. hypnotic
D. prestigious

109. Since this is an age of _____, young people cannot afford to enter the field of labor with out training in some specific area.
A. generalization
B. specialization
C. imitation
D. automation

110. The _____ of evidence was on the side of the plaintiff since all but one witness testified that his story was correct.
A. paucity
B. majority
C. accuracy
D. preponderance

111. A _____ statement is an _____ comparison: it doesnot compare things explicitly, but suggests a likeness between them.

A. blatant...overt
B. sarcastic...unfair
C. metaphorical....implied
D. bellicose...ardent

112. Such a _____ charge was grounds for a suit claiming ____
A. preposterous...libel
B. meritorious...slander
C. slanderous...posterity
D. veracious...perjury

113. The prosecuting attorney could not _____ the advertising tactics.
A. condone...misleading
B. cower...conspicuous
C. covert...concealed
D. praise...cursory

114. Children in China and Japan have always been taught to _____ their elders.
A. estimate
B. eradicate
C. venerate
D. vitiate

115. She is so _____ that she is unable to listen to any ____ of her work.
A. impartial...censure
B. sensitive...criticism
C. innocent...defense
D. generous...slander

116. Modern architecture has discarded the _____ trimming on buildings and has concentrated on an almost Greek simplicity of line.
A. flamboyant
B. colorful
C. aesthetic
D. derivative

117. If you are seeking _____ that will resolve all our ailments, you are undertaking an impassive task
A. a direction
B. a contrivance
C. a precedent
D. a panacea

118. It was painful enough to sit in that overheated room; it was made worse by the uninspired and _____ words of the speaker.
A. heated B. cogent C. vapid D. laconic

119. I have no _____ motive in offering this advice; I seek no personal advantage or honor.
A. ulterior B. skeptical C. unusual D. incongruous

120. If I understand what you are trying to _____ by that remark, I find it in very poor taste.
A. intimidate
C. insinuate

B. interpret
D. cavil

121. This park has been preserved in all its _____ wildness so that visitors in future years may see how people lived during the eighteenth century.

A. vivid
B. prospective
C. hedonistic
D. pristine

22. Since he was overpowered from the _____, he had no idea who his _____ might have been.

A. rear…assailant
B. scent…enchanters
C. front…attacker
D. start…seducer

23. The ball was a complete _____; even the orchestra was _____.

A. fiasco…incompetent
B. disaster…applauded
C. travesty…magnificent
D. triumph…stupefied

4. Though he was theoretically a friend of labor, his voting record in congress _____ that impression.

A. created
B. implied
C. belied
D. maintained

5. The orator was so _____ that the audience became _____.

A. inaudible…elated
B. pompous…bombastic
C. soporific…drowsily
D. dramatic…affable

6. When you send me a statement of your expenses, I'll _____ you.

A. reimburse
B. restore
C. audit
D. reinstate

7. If you carry this _____ attitude to the conference, you'll any supporters you may have at this moment.

A. ubiquitous…delight
B. belligerent…delight
C. conciliatory…defer
D. truculent…alienate

8. Before any agreement can be signed, the workers insist that a guarantee be given that no _____ against the strikers will be taken.

A. revenge
B. penalties
C. reprisals
D. attacks

129. He was guided by _____ rather than by ethical considerations.
A. precepts
B. expediency
C. morality
D. sophistry

130. His _____ stories shocked the ladies in his audience and repelled the men.
A. pithy
B. ribald
C. eloquent
D. disparaging

131. It is _____ that the best prepared student in the class should have to resort to _____.
A. ironic…cheating
B. amusing…subterfuge
C. grave…facetiousness
D. paradoxical…research

132. We must try to understand his momentary _____ for he has _____ more stain and anxiety than any among us.
A. senility…understood
B. vision…forgotten
C. outcry…described
D. aberration…undergone

133. An occasional _____ remark spoiled the _____ that made the paper memorable.
A. urbane…sophistication
B. colloquial…verisimilitude
C. hackneyed…originality
D. trite…clichés

134. The prodigal son _____ the family fortune.
A. inherited
B. squandered
C. saved
D. converted

135. If you behave from now on, I will _____ this notation from your record card.
A. enter
B. absolve
C. expurgate
D. extract

136. He is _____ opponents; you must respect and fear him at all times.
A. a craven
B. a courageous
C. a redoubtable
D. a dubious

137. We need more men of culture and enlightenment; we've too many _____ among us.

A. philistines
B. boors
C. students
D. philosophers

It is foolish to vent your sleen on _____ enemies that way.

A. an interesting...curious
B. an immobile...bitter
C. an inanimate...fewer
D. a humane...more

The complicated directions were so _____ that the taxi driver became lost and caused his passengers to miss their plane.

A. extraneous
B. misleading
C. spontaneous
D. concise

He was so convinced that people were driven by _____ motives that he could not believe that anyone could be unselfish.

A. intangible
B. altruistic
C. intrinsic
D. ulterior

He worked _____ at his task for weeks before he felt satisfied that the results justified his long effort.

A. sporadically
B. intermittently
C. occasionally
D. assiduously

The judge asked the two opposing sides of the dispute to try to reach a settlement by _____ on the issues.

A. compromising
B. deciding
C. harassing
D. requesting

I intend to wait for a more _____ occasion before I announce my plans.

A. prodigious
B. pathetic
C. propitious
D. pronounced

His _____ but well-meaning remarks are often embarrassing because of their frankness.

A. ingenuous
B. sarcastic
C. sardonic
D. sadistic

145. American do not feel that _____ obedience and implicit submission to the will of another is necessary in order to maintain good government.
A. blind
B. partial
C. verbal
D. logical

146. The charm of an _____ speech is that it seems _____ and unrchearsed.
A. improvised...callow
B. appealing...entertaining
C. elaborate...disorganized
D. impromptu...spontaneous

147. His theories where so _____ that few could see what he was trying to say.
A. scholarly
B. nebulous
C. logical
D. orderly

148. The language was _____ but the essay revealed some ___ thoughts.
A. hackneyed...original
B. elastic...resilient
C. violent...vivid
D. trite...boring

149. Modern designers of industrial appliances are concerned with _____ as well as
A. competition...price
B. design...shape
C. appearance...performance
D. competition...price

150. The concept of _____ grouping of people with similar interests and abilities was very popular among educators.
A. heterogeneous
B. homogeneous
C. integrated
D. segregated

151. After several _____ attempts to send the missile into space, the space craft was finally launched.
A. successful
B. accidental
C. abortive
D. coercive

152. After an _____ delay, the passengers were told that the ship would not sail because of a labor dispute.
A. exhaustive
B. interminable
C. indescribable
D. equivocal

153. A passport is _____ for a period of five years; after that, it must be renewed.

A. valid
B. diplomatic
C. guaranteed
D. applicable

154. The slogan "Equal pay for equal work" refers to the unacceptable _____ between the wages of men and women in occupations of similar difficulty, risk, and educational level.

A. parity
B. ambivalence
C. equivalence
D. discrepancy

155. He felt like a _____, as everyone shunned him.

A. pariah
B. ambivalence
C. protagonist
D. misanthrope

156. Because the inspector gave the plant _____examination, he _____ many defects.

A. pertinent…unveiled
B. significant…neglected
C. routine…discovered
D. perfunctory….overlooked

157. The ties that bind us together in common activity are so ___ that they can disappear at any moment.

A. brittle
B. animated
C. tenuous
D. tentative

158. The actors tried valiantly to surmount the weaknesses of the _____ dialogue and hackneyed plot.

A. brittle
B. animated
C. trite
D. witty

159. His listeners enjoyed his _____ wit but his victims often _ at its satire.

A. caustic…laughed
B. kindly…smarted
C. trenchant…winced
D. subtle…smiled

160. Automation threatens mankind with a greater number of ___ hours.

A. idle
B. filled
C. useless
D. active

161. As _____ as the painting is, it also reveals the artist, namely a lack of gravity and of emotional depth.
   A. successful...weaknesses
   B. tasteless...strengths
   C. aesthetic...virtues
   D. crude...limitations

162. You are afraid to attack him directly; you, therefore, are restoring to _____.
   A. innuendo
   B. condemnation
   C. criticism
   D. effrontery

163. His voice has a _____ quality that is more appropriate at a funeral than a class reunion.
   A. lanquid
   B. static
   C. lachrymose
   D. raucous

164. By his _____ manner, he conveyed the impression that he was accustomed to assuming.
   A. imperious
   B. furtive
   C. languid
   D. obsequious

165. He went to the _____ for treatment of his ingrown toenail.
   A. pediatrician
   B. chiropodist
   C. cardiologist
   D. chiropractor

166. No act of _____ was more pronounced than his refusal of any rewards for his discovery.
   A. abeyance
   B. submission
   C. abnegation
   D. egoism

167. His _____ were not discovered until the authors found discrepancies in the financial statements.
   A. peculations
   B. speculations
   C. computations
   D. erasures

168. I find it difficult to understand how you can _____ in this quiet village after the adventurous life you have led.
   A. frolic
   B. mediate
   C. vegetate
   D. desecrate

169. His _____ nature could not be repressed; he was always laughing and gay.
   A. dissipated
   B. ebullient
   C. saturnine
   D. extrovertish

170. The plot of this story is so _____ that I can predict its outcome.
A. clever
B. involved
C. insipid
D. trite

171. His blood _____ in his veins as he saw the dread monster rush toward him.
A. flowed
B. congealed
C. burst
D. concentrated

172. He was not _____ and preferred to be alone most of the time.
A. gracious
B. antisocial
C. cordial
D. gregarious

173. Ecomius are words of _____
A. pomposity
B. lamentation
C. poetry
D. praise

174. He didn't have a serious approach to painting; he was rather a _____.
A. tyro
B. dilettante
C. gamester
D. zealot

175. Because she considered herself a perfect ionist, she was not able to _____ any errors made by her employees.
A. suggest
B. advance
C. advise
D. tolerate

176. At such a serious moment in our history, your _____ is in appropriate and in bad taste.
A. levity
B. attire
C. moodness
D. naturation

177. I can recommend him for this position because I have always found him _____ and reliable.
A. voracious
B. veracious
C. vindictive
D. volorous

178. The members of religious sect ostracized the _____ who had abandoned their faith.
A. coward
B. suppliant
C. litigant
D. recreant

179. I am not attracted by the _____ life of the _____, always wandering through the country side, begging for charity.
A. natural…philosopher
B. urban…hobo
C. peripatetic…vagabond
D. proud…almsgiver

180. Her true feelings _____ themselves in her sarcastic a sides; only then was her _____ revealed.
A. hid … sarcasm
B. grieved…charm
C. concealed…sweetness
D. manifested…bitterness

Answer Key

1. A	31. A	61. C	91. B	121. D	151.C
2. C	32. D	62. B	92. A	122. A	152.B
3. E	33. A	63. A	93. A	123. A	153.A
4. A	34. D	64. D	94. D	124. C	154.D
5. B	35. A	65. D	95. C	125. C	155.A
6. B	36. B	66. C	96. A	126. A	156.D
7. D	37. A	67. A	97. A	127. D	157.C
8. A	38. C	68. A	98. D	128. C	158.C
9. C	39. C	69. D	99. B	129. B	159.C
10. A	40. C	70. A	100.A	130. B	160.A
11. B	41. A	71. B	101.D	131. A	161.A
12. A	42. B	72. B	102.C	132. D	162.A
13. D	43. B	73. D	103.C	133. C	163.C
14. C	44. C	74. D	104.B	134. B	164.A
15. A	45. B	75. A	105.D	135. C	165.B
16. C	46. D	76. A	106.A	136. C	166.C
17. B	47. C	77. C	107.C	137. A	167.A
18. D	48. A	78. C	108.A	138. C	168.C
19. A	49. A	79. B	109.B	139. B	169.B
20. D	50. D	80. C	110.D	140. D	170.D
21. A	51. B	81. A	111.C	141. D	171.B
22. B	52. B	82. D	112.A	142. A	172.D
23. B	53. C	83. A	113.A	143. C	173.D
24. B	54. B	84. A	114.C	144. A	174.B
25. A	55. B	85. C	115.B	145. A	175.D
26. C	56. C	86. A	116.A	146. D	176.A
27. D	57. C	87. C	117.D	147. B	177.B
28. A	58. A	88. A	118.C	148. A	178.D
29. B	59. C	89. C	119.A	149. C	179.C
30. C	60. A	90. C	120.C	150. B	180.D

UNIT FIVE

LANGUAGE USAGE

(standard written English)

Usage Questions And Sentence Correction

In **Usage Questions,** four words or groups of words will be underlined in each sentence. You'll be asked to find the **error**, if there is one, in one of the underlined parts. You don't have to correct the sentence; you only have to correct the sentence; you only have to identify the **error**.

With **sentence correction Questions** you have to do more than just spot the error. You have to find the correction as well. These questions give you sentences in which one section is underlined. The answer choices repeat the underlined section and give you four other versions of the same section. You must decide which version is best. Many of these questions cover errors in the structure or logic of a sentence.

Usage Questions Tactics

1. In most cases, you should be able to spot the error when you read sentence. Think how it would sound if you were to read it would sound if you were to read it aloud. Pay special attention to any phrases that sound awkward.
2. If you cannot identify the error immediately. Use the following check list:
   a. If the underlined part is noun, look for errors is case, agreement with verb, parallel structure, and direction.
   b. If the underlined part is pronoun, look for errors in case, agreement with antecedent, agreement with verb, parallel structure, and diction.
   c. If the underlined part is verb, look for errors in agreement with subject, tense, mood, parallel, structure, and diction.

d. If the underlined part is an adjective, look for errors in degree of comparison and in diction. Make certain that the word modifies a noun or pronoun.
e. If the underlined part is an adverb, look for errors in degree of comparision and in diction. Make certain that the word modifies a verb, an adjective, or another adverb.
f. If the underlined part is a participle, check whether it has a word to modify in the sentence. Otherwise, it is a dangling participle.
g. If the underlined part is a phrase, look for errors, in sentence structure and in parallel structure.
h. If the underlined part is a clause, look for errors in sentence structure and in parallel structure.
i. If you find no errors, choose E as your answer.

Sentence Correction Questions Tactics

1. Use the check list supplied above to test for errors in the underlined part of the sentence.
2. Examine the four or five choices provided to find the one which corrects the error you have found.
3. Note that there may be more than one error in the underlined part. Be sure to correct all errors.
4. Don't change the meaning of the sentence when you make correction.
5. If you think the underlined part is correct, you should select choice **"A"** as your answer choice **"A"** repeats the underlined part without any changes.

UNIVERSITY ENTRANCE EXAMINATION AND OTHERS QUESTIONS WITH ANSWER AND EXPLANATIONS. (2001-2009)

✧ The following sentences contain problems in **grammar, usage, diction (choice of words)**, and **idioms**.

Some sentences are correct.
No sentence contains more than one error.
You'll find that the error, if there is one, is underlined and lettered.
Assume that elements of the sentence that are not underlined are correct

and cannot be changed. In choosing answers, follow the requirements of standard written English.
If there is an error, select the **one underlined part** that must be changed to make the sentence correct. If there is no error choose **"E"**.

Every one of the candidates for the position is submitting an
(A) (B)
application and three letters of recommendation attesting
their fitness for the job. No error
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: **Error** in agreement between pronoun and antecedent.
→ Change **their** to **his** or **her.**
Answer: C

Not one of the members of the football team have left that the
(A) (B) (C)
coach was not qualified to lead the group. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: **Error** in agreement between subject and predicate
→ Change **have left** to **has left**.
Answer: C

The committee announced that an award of 500,000 Birr would
be
(A) (B)
given to whomever first discovered a cure for this disease.
(C) (D)

No error.
(E)

Clues: **Error** in case. The subject of the verb **discovered** should be in the nominative case.
→ Change **whomever** to **whoever**.
Answer: C

4. Neither the soldiers in the company nor lieutenant in change of
(C)
the
(A) (B)
group have any idea when any relief will arrive. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: In **neither...nor** construction, the verb aggress with the noun or pronoun which immediately precedes the noun or pronoun which immediately precedes.

→ Since **lieutenant** is singular, the verb must be singular.

→ Change **have** to **has**.

Answer: D

5. After all our guests left our apartment, we began the tedious task
(A) (B) (C)
of cleaning the living room and the dining area. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: **Error** in sequence of tenses change **left** to **had left**

Answer: B

6. Despite all our efforts, the fire blazed out of control and the
(A) (B)
entire two-story building was demolished. No error
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: There is no **error** in this sentences.

Answer: E

7. When I brung my term paper to the teacher. I was told that my
(A) (B)
handwriting was illegible and that I should take it home and type
(C) (D)
it. No error
(E)

Clues: **Error** in conjugation.

→ Change **brung** to **brought**.

Answer: A

8. During the late Gothic period, virtually all the elaborately figured
(A) (B)
wall hanging were those that are intricately woven by communities
(C) (D)
of Belgian weavers. No error
(E)

Clues: **Error** in sequence of tenses.

→ Change **are intricately** to **were intricately**.

Answer: D

I believe the author is inferring that war, although horrible, can be
(A) (B) (C)
a mixed blessing. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: **Error** in diction.

→ Change **inferring** to **implying**.

Answer: A

10. With the coming of winter, we are looking forward to ice-skating,
(A) (B) (C)
tobogganing, and to learn how to operate a snowmobile. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is lack of parallel structure.

→ Change **to learn how** to **learning**.

Answer: D

11. Working against time, the rescue party tried to drill a hole parallel
(A) (B) (C)
to the dry well into which the old woman had fallen. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence.

Answer: E

12. A good home computer can be a valuable educational toll for you;
(A)
either the Apple II or the Radio shack model III are what you
(C)
(B)
are looking for. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: In **either...or** construction, the verb agrees with the noun or pronoun which immediately precedes it.

→ Change **are** to **is**.

Answer: C

13. Mrs. Senait, our neighbor, is one of the woman (among many
women) who
(A)
has been invited to the Governors conference on the problems of

(B) (C)
the elderly. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: **Error** is the lack of agreement between subject and verb.
→ Change **has been invited** to **have been invited**.

Note that the antecedent of **who** is woman. **Who**, therefore, is plural and requires a plural verb.

Answer: B

14. Irregardless of the fact that I was also partly to blame, I cannot
(A) (B) (C)
forgive what he did. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: **Error** is in diction. There is no such word as **irregardless**.
→ Change to **regardless**.

Answer: A

15. If Moti had been more alert, he could have avoided the collision
(A) (B) (C)
which wrecked his car. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence.

Answer: E

16. I would react to that suggestion similarly if I was in charge of
(A) (B) (C)
supervising this activity. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in mood. A condition contrary to fact statement requires a verb in the subjunctive mood.
→ Change **was** to **were**.

Answer: C

17. If one wishes to succeed in school work, you must attend all
(A) (B) (C)
classes, do all your class work, and hand in all assignments on time. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: In this sentence there is an unnecessary shift in the person of the pronouns.
→ Change **'one wishes'** to **'you wish'**

Answer: B

18. Kasahun was living in his apartment house for two years before he
(A) (B)
met his next-door neighbor. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in tense.

→ Change **was living** to **had been living.** **Answer: A**

19. When the kitchen was remodeled last summer, neither the butcher
(A) (B) (C)
block counter nor the wood floor were refinished. No error.
(D)

Clues: The **error** is in agreement in a **neither…nor** construction the verb agrees with the noun or pronoun which precedes it.

→ Change **were finished** to **was finished.** **Answer: D**

20. The headmaster suspended Girma for a week because he had cut
(A) (B)
several consecutive classes and had insulted her science teacher.
(C) (D)
No error.
(E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence. **Answer: E**

21. Do you realize the affect this news will have on Tayech when she
(A) (B) (C)
reads about it. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in diction. **Answer: B**

→ Change **affect** to **effect.**

22. In his famous soliloquy, Hamlet thinks of death as a means of
(A)
being rid from all worldly cares. No error.
(B) (C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in **idiom.** → Change **'from'** to **'of'.** **Answer: C**

23. I donot mind Solomon's telling that story to my friends; I resent
(A) (B)
him relating it to people who dislike me. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in case. The pronoun preceding a gerund **(relating)** should be in possessive case.

→ Change **'him'** to **'his'**.

Answer: C

24. Mary is jealous of people like you and I and shows her resentment
(A) (B) (C)
in many different and subtle ways. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in case. **Like** is a preposition and should be followed by a pronoun in the objective case.

→ Change **'I'** to **'me'**.

Answer: B

25. I hope you will vote for whoever is the best candidate for the
(A) (B) (C) (D)
position. No error.
(E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence.

Answer: E

26. This purse is the most loveliest of all the gift I received for my
(A) (B) (C)
birthday. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in comparison.

→ Change **'most loveliest'** to either **'most lovely** or **loveliest**.

Answer: A

27. The reason why I was late is because the subway train broke down
(A) (B) (C)
in the tunnel and we had to wait for more than an hour. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: Grammarians dislike the expression **'the reason is because'** → Change **'because'** to **'that'**.

Answer: B

28. I felt real (A) sorry for her, and, therefore, (B) I let (C) her go with only a (D) warning. No error. (E)

Clues: The **error** is the misuse of adjective for adverb.

→ Change '**real** to **really**'

Answer: A

29. Since (A) Ronaldo has made more spectacular (B) plays than any other (C) player on the field, he should be given (D) the most valuable player award. No error. (E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence. **Answer: E**

30. Now that (A) you are using this skin lotion, your complexion has become clearer (B) and you look (C) more levier. (D) No error. (E)

Clues: The **error** is in comparison of adjectives.

→ Change '**lovelier** to **lovely**.

Answer: D

31. Our team of debates have proved (A) itself the best (B) in the division; having won all its matches this year. No error. (C) (D) (E)

Clues: A collective noun can be regarded as either singular or plural. However, the use of the words **itself** and **its** in this sentence indicates that the author regards **team** as singular.

→ Change '**have proved** to **has proved**'.

Answer: A

32. If Roba would have felt (A) any pity for his opponent, (B) he would have

ended the about sooner than he did. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in mood. The subjunctive mood is needed in a condition contrary to fact statement.

→ Change **'would have left** to **had left'.**

Answer: A

33. Shimelis practiced intensively and as a result he is now better than
(A) (B)
any member of his team. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Answer: E

34. In this modern age, many people find talking on the phone to their
(A) (B)
friends more satisfying than to write. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in parallel structure.

→ Change **'to write** to **writing'**.

Answer: D

35. As the spectators ran for shelter from the sudden thunderstorm
(A) (B)
which was drenching the stadium. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is a sentence fragment.

→ Remove **'As'**

Answer: A

36. The other members of the committee are not at fault; it is I who is
(A) (B) (C)
responsible for the failure of our enterprise. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in agreement between pronoun and verb. **Who** in this sentence is a first person singular pronoun because its antecedent is **I**. The verb should also be first person singular.

→ Change **'is** to **am'**.

Answer: C

37. One of the many factors which are influencing my decision is the
(A) (B) (C)
element of cost. No error
(D) (E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence.

Answer: E

I shop at the supermarket because it is cheaper and having a greater
(A)
variety of foods than the local grocery store. No error.
(B) (C) (D) (E)

Clues: There **error** is the lack of parallel structure.
→ Change '**having** to **has**'.

Answer: B

By the time the fire engines arrived at the scene, the janitor
(A) (B)
extinguished the blaze and the tenants were returning to their
(C) (D)
homes. No error.
(E)

Clues: The **error** is in sequence of tenses.
→ Change '**extinguished** to **had extinguished**.

Answer: C

40. Among Tesfaye, Gemechu, and I, there can be no secrets. No error.
(A) (B) (C) (D) (E)

Clues: There **error** is in case
→ Change '**I** to **me**' because the pronoun is the object of the preposition **among**.

Answer: B

41. Mr. Tsegaye's decision to retire came as a shock to all who
(A) (B) (C) (D)
respected his ability. No error.
(E)

Clues: No **error** in this sentence.

Answer: E

42. We had ought to finish our trip before dark because it gets very
(A) (B) (C)
cold after the sun goes down. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in diction.
→ Change **had ought** to **ought.**

Answer: A

43. The fishing fleet left the harbor when the fishermen heard that a
(A) (B)
school of bluefish were near the wreck. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in lack of agreement. **School** is singular and should be followed by **was (singular)** **Answer: C**

44. The workers who I see in the subway every after noon seem tired
(A) (B) (C)
and dejected. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in case. The pronoun should be **whom** because it is the object of the verb **see**. **Answer: A**

45. Turning the pages rapidly does not guarantee rapid comprehension.
(A) (B) (C) (D)
No error.
(E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence. **Answer: E**

46. Bailing vigorously, we managed to remain afloat until we were
(A) (B) (C) (D)
rescued by the coast guard. No error.
(E)

Clues: No error exists in this sentence. **Answer: E**

47. Does that remark infer that you are displeased with the way I am
(A) (B) (C)
managing the business? No error
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in diction. → Change **infer** to **imply**. **Answer: B**

48. It is not you who are at fault; rather, it is I who is to blame.
(A) (B) (C) (D)
No error.
(E)

Clues: The **error** is in lack of agreement. The antecedent of **who** is **I**, therefore, should be followed by **am**. **Answer: D**

Please notify all those whom you think should have this
(A) (B) (C) (D)
information. No error.
(E)

Clues: The **error** is in case. The subject of **should have** is **who**, not **whom**.
Answer: C

The ideal that Arthur and his knights were in quest of were a
(A) (B) (C)
better world order. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in agreement. The subject of the verb is **ideal** (singular). → Change **were** to **was**.
Answer: C

I am sure that he has been here and did what was expected of him.
(A) (B) (C) (D)
No error.
(E)

Clues: The **error** is in **tense**. → Change '**did** to **has done**'.
Answer: C

The ship had almost completely sank by the time the rescuers
(A) (B) (C)
arrived on the scene. No error.
(D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in tense. The past perfect tense of **sink** is **had sink.**
Answer: B

Since you do not participate in any of the class activities. I must
(A) (B)
conclude that you are disinterested. No error.
(C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in **diction**. Use **uninterested** instead of **disinterested.**
Answer: D

54. He can't hardly (A) do anything (B) with his right hand ever (C) since he had (D) his stroke. No error. (E)

Clues: The **error** is in double negative (can't hardly)
→ Change **'can't hardly** to **can hardly'**

Answer: A

55. You should take your umbrella when you go out because it is liable (A) to rain this afternoon. No error. (B) (C) (D) (E)

Clues: The **error** is in diction. Use **likely** instead of **liable**.

Answer: C

56. I cannot force myself (A) to like that (B) kind of person (C) because his smugness repels (D) me. No error. (E)

Clues: The **error** is in diction. Delet the article **'a'**

Answer: C

57. I was irritated (A) by the special relationship between (B) you and him; (C) I thought you were playing (D) favorites. No error. (E)

Clues: There is no error in this sentence.

Answer: E

58. All that time, it was her (A) whom (B) I held responsible for (C) the calamity which had occurred (D) to our family. No error. (E)

Clues: The **error** is in case. The predicate complement of a copulative verb **(was)** is in the nominative case.
→ Change **her** to **she**

Answer: A

59. If he had kept (A) his eyes open (B), he would not have fallen (C) into that t trap. No error. (D) (E)

Clues: No error with this sentence.

Answer: E

In each of the following sentences. Some part or all of the sentence is underlined. Below each sentence you'll find five or four ways of phrasing the underlined part. The answer that produces the most effective sentence will be selected. (The one that is clear and exact, without awkwardness or ambiguity).

60. If I had went to the store for my mother, I would have bought pizza rolls for my lunch.

A. If I had went to the store
B. if I had gone to the store
C. if I would have went to the store
D. I would got o the store

Clues: The past participle of **go** is **gone**. **Answer: B**

61. The telephone has brought people together more than any invention.

A. more than any invention
B.- more than any invention has
C. more than has any other invention
D. more than has any invention
E. more than any other invention

Clues: The faulty comparison is corrected in choice **'E'**. **Answer: E**

62. I never said and never will that you are not the best candidate for this high office.

A. I never said and never will
B. I never have said and never will
C. I never said and never shall
D. I never have said and never shall I say
E. I never said and never will say.

Clues: The improper omission of the verb is corrected in choice **E**. **Answer: E**

63. Shakespearean scholars are reaching no quick consensus about the newly-discovered poem attributed to the bared, but some of them discrediting it.

A. Some of them discrediting it
B. some of them are discrediting it
C. some of them having discredited it
D. it is discredited by some of them
E. it is being discredited

Clues: The improper omission of the verb is corrected in chore **(B)**

Answer: B

64. Although it was obvious that Chala felt badly about the effect of his impulsive words, we decided that further punishment was in order.

A. felt badly about the affect
B. felt badly about the effect
C. felt badly about the effect
D. seemed sorry about the affect
E. felt bad about the effect

Clues: Copulative verbs like **feel** should be followed by an adjective. **Affect** should not be used used as a noun. Both errors are corrected in choice (D).

Answer: D

65. Starting that he couldn't eat hardly anything.

A. he couldn't eat hardly anything
B. hardly anything could be eaten
C. he could eat hardly anything
D. he couldn't' eat hardly nothing
E. he couldn't eat scarcely anything

Clues: The double negative found in choices **A, D,** and **E** is corrected in choice **(C).** Choice **B** changes the meaning of the sentence.

Answer: C

66. Walking on this slippery surface, one must use care to avoid accidents.

A. One must use care to avoid accidents
B. care must be used to avoid accidents
C. accidents can be avoided by using care
D. you must avoid accidents by using care
E. he couldn't eat scarcely anything

Choices **(B)** and **C** create a dangling participle. Choice **(D)** changes the meaning of the sentence. The comma makes choice **E** incorrect. **Answer: A**

eethoven wrote nine symphonies; and they are still being played n orchestras all over the world.

symphonies: and they are still
symphonies which are still
symphonies. And they are still
symphonies, and they are still
symphonies: which are still

Choice **(B)** corrects the errors in punctuating found in the other choice. **Answer: B**

e expected the plane to be late, due to the announcement that ny fogs had delayed its takeoff.

we expected the plane to be late, due to
we expected the plane will be late, because of
we expected the plane would be late due to
we anticipated that the plane would be late, due to
we expected the plane to be late because of

Choices **(A, C,** and **D)** suffer from the misuse of **due to.** Choice **(B)** contains an error in tense. **Answer: E**

First you mix the batter and then the cake is baked.

First you mix the batter and then the cake is baked.
First you mix the batter and then you bake the cake.
The first step is to mix the batter and then you bake the cake.
First the batter is mixed and then you bake the cake.
Mix the batter first before the cake you baked.

Choices **A, C, D** and **E** contain an unnecessary shift from the active voice to the passive voice. **Answer: B**

e couldn't of finished without you're helping

we couldn't of finished without your help
we couldn't' have finished without your help
we cold not of finished without your helping
we couldn't have finished without you're help
we cannot finish without your helping.

Clues: Choices **A, C, D** and **E** contain either or both of the errors in diction found in this question: **'couldn't of'** instead of **'couldn't have** and **you're** instead of **your**.

Answer: B

71. Wildly unscientific medical remedies, such as bleeding people with leeches, were practiced for centuries, and they showed no sign of doing the patients any good.

A. centuries, and they showed
B. centuries that showed
C. centuries they showed
D. centuries, however, they showed
E. centuries though they showed

Clues: The introduction of the conjunction **'though'** clarifies the relationship between the clauses.

Answer: E

72. In the Middle Ages, a lord's intricate wall hangings were more than mere tapestries they were a measure of his consequence and wealth.

A. mere tapestries they were a measure
B. merely tapestries they were a measure
C. mere tapestries and were a measure
D. mere tapestries; they were a measure
E. mere tapestries, while they were a measure

Clues: The use of the **semicolon** both corrects the run-on sentences and effectively contrasts the two clauses.

Answer: D

73. Having rang the bell, the class came to order.

A. Having rang the bell, the class came to order
B. ringing the bell, the class came to order
C. the bell having rang, the class came to order
D. with the bell having rang, the class came to order
E. the bell having rung, the class came to order

Clues: Choices (**A** and **C**) have a dangling participle; choices **B** and **D** contain an error in conjugation. (**rang** instead of **rung**)

Answer: E

Senator Wagner was one of the leaders of the Democratic Party who was sympathetic to the cause of labor.

A. Who was sympathetic to the cause of labor
B. Who were sympathetic to the cause of labor
C. Which was in sympathy with labor
D. who was in sympathy with labor
E. and they were in sympathy with labor.

→ **(study)**

Answer: B

With the exception of Tigist and I, everyone in the class finished the assignment before the bell rang.

A. Tigist and I, every one in the class finished
B. Tigist and me, every one in the class finished
C. Tigist and me, every one in the class had finished
D. Tigist and I, every one in the class had finished
E. Tigist and me, every one in the class finished

Clues: This corrects the two errors in this sentence the error in case (**me** for **I**) and the error in tense (**had finished** for **finished**)

Answer: C

76. Many middle class individuals find that they can't obtain good medical attention, despite they need it badly.

A. despite they need it badly
B. despite their bad need of it
C. in spite of they need it badly
D. however much they need it.

Clues: **Despite** should be used as a preposition (**it is followed by phrase**)

Answer: B

77. When one eats in this restaurant, you often find that the food is poorly prepared.

A. When one eats in this restaurant, you often find
B. When you eat in this restaurant, you often find
C. As you eat in this restaurant, one often find
D. If you eat in this restaurant, you often find
E. When one ate in this restaurant, he often, found

Clues: Unnecessary shift of pronoun. Do not shift from **you** to **one**.

Answer: C

Review Exercise

1. Expect for Alem and I, everyone in the room finished the test
(A) (B) (C)
within the prescribed time. No error.
(D) (E)

2. Frankly, the only ones who voted against your admission into the
(A) (B) (C)
club were Fasil and he. No error.
(D) (E)

3. Ruth doesn't like to eat these kind of fried foods; she prefers salads and raw vegetables
   A. these kind of tried foods;
   B. them kinds of tried foods;
   C. these kinds of tried foods;
   D. those kind of tried foods;
   E. these kinds of tried foods;

4. If I was he, I would declined to attend the reception
   A. If I was he
   B. If I was him
   C. Were I him
   D. If I would be he
   E. If I were he

5. Because Samuel is on the football team for the three seasons, he
(A) (B) (C)
will be elected captain this year. No error.
(D) (E)

6. I knew that the room had been recently renovated; the smell from
(A) (B) (C)
the fresh paint still pervaded the atmosphere. No error.
(D) (E)

7. Taye published his first book and he was sixty years old then.
   A. and he was sixty years old then
   B. when he was sixty years old
   C. at age sixty years old
   D. upon reaching sixty years
   E. at the time when he was sixty

8. Our team of debaters <u>have proved</u> itself <u>best</u> in the division, <u>having</u>
(A) (B) (C)
won all <u>its</u> matches this year. <u>No error</u>
(D) (E)

9. I had <u>differently</u> deciding <u>between</u> Ebisa and Bontu, but I <u>finally</u>
(A) (B) (C)
voted for the <u>latter</u>. <u>No error</u>
(D) (E)

10. By working with a tutor for six weeks, <u>his grades were raised</u> to the point where his teachers were willing to promote him.
A. his grades were raised
B. his grades improved
C. he raised his grades
D. his raising of the grades
E. his grades had risen

11. To be rich and successful is <u>good</u>; <u>but to be healthy and happy is best</u>.
A. good; but to be healthy and happy is best
B. good, to be healthy and happy is better
C. good; to be healthy and happy is better
D. good; to be healthy and happy is best
E. good: to be healthy and happy is better.

12. The Manager of the team tested several players <u>who he taught</u> could play in the infield.
A. who he thought
B. whom he thought
C. which he thought
D. he tought who
E. of whom he thought

13. Kaleb maintained that he was <u>enamored by</u> the natural wonders of Yosemite National Park.
A. enamored by
B. enamored of
C. enamored with
D. inspired at
E. enthused with

14. After (A) all our guests left (B), we had (C) the unpleasant job of cleaning the (D) apartment. No error (E)

15. Ato Musema was annoyed by (A) his wife taking (B) a job without (C) consulting him. No error. (D) (E)

16. The reason for the delay in handling in this manuscript is due to the fact that my wife was very ill.
   A. due to the fact that my wife was very ill
   B. because my wife was very ill
   C. that my wife was very ill
   D. because of my wife's illness
   E. due to illness of my wife

17. Being that Roba is that kind of an athlete, he should be encouraged to try out for a part in the school play.
   A. being that Roba is that kind of athlete
   B. being that he is that kind of athlete
   C. since he is that kind of an athlete
   D. because he is that kind of an athlete
   E. since Roba is that kind of athlete

18. 'You must realize (A) that we are altogether (B) in this venture (C); if one of us drop out (D), all of us will fall. No error (E)

19. Martha is as quick as (A) if not quicker than (B) Abebe or (C) Alemu in solving (D) crossword puzzles. No error (E)

20. The packages have been wrapped and are all ready to be mailed as soon as the courier arrives.
   A. have been wrapped and are all ready to be mailed
   B. are wrapped and are already to be mailed
   C. have been wrapped and are already for mailing
   D. are being wrapped and will be already for mailing
   E. are being and will already to mail

Answer Key

1.	B	6.	C	11.	C	16.	C
2.	E	7.	C	12.	A	17.	E
3.	E	8.	A	13.	B	18.	B
4.	E	9.	E	14.	B	19.	E
5.	B	10.	C	15.	B	20.	A

Resume/CV Plus Job Interview

When employers advertise for a post they perhaps search someone with best skills and competencies for the job. To that effect, their screening procedure much of the time goes through the candidates resume/CV and interview. But on the other side, most candidates are not familiar enough with the know-how to prepare communicative resume and perform fruitful interview.

This unit is thus intended to provide candidates with fundamental points that can surely avoid the shortcomings. It states the key informations to be included in CV and cover letter and attaches their functional samples. It explains how to prepare for an interview, what strategies to use and how to act on it.

Furthermore, commonly asked interview questions - each of them followed by good to know points, and a sample job interview are available.

9.1 Resume/CV (is an abbreviation for curriculum vitae) and cover letter.

9.1.1 A resume/CV is a brief account of personal details, education, experience or the jobs you have had and references.

• **Sample CV**

Name:
Personal details Wakuma Gurmessa
Date of birth 17/04/83
Address Arsi Ticho
Phone 09123984663
Mobile 07764733689
Email wakgurmesa@hots.com

Profile A highly – motivated, well – travelled, and enthusiastic graduate, with practical experience of working with children of all ages.

Education Assela High school
Adama University (BA in psychology)

Work Experience - June 2000 supervisor
- July 2001 Coach at training centre
- June 2003 teaching assistant at secondary school

Interest - Dance, athletics, volleyball

Additional information - One of my main interests is dance, which I have done since I was three, passing many exams and performing in annual dance festivals. I have organized sports events and training sessions for dance. I have travelled throughout my country.

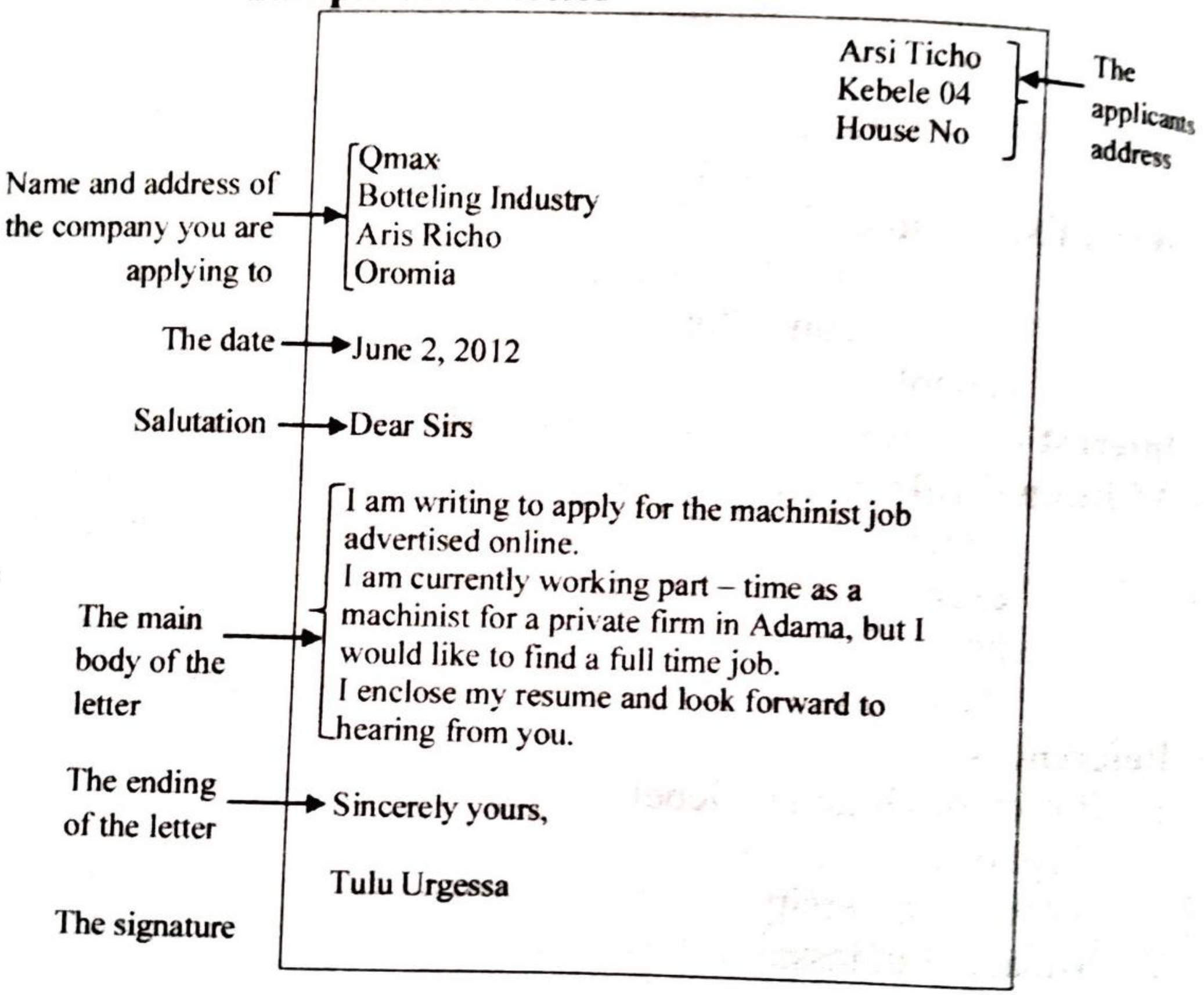
References
1. Professor Guluma Alebel
   Dept of Economics
   Adama University
2. Mulatu Hundessa
   Head teacher
   Arsi High school
   Phone 0977 87 97 97

9.2 Cover/Covering letter

* Cover letter is a formal letter enclosed with resume and credentials as an explanation or to provide extra information.
* Good to know that cover letter consists the following parts.
  A) The applicants address

B) The name and address of the company the applicant is applying to
C) The date
D) Salutation
E) The main body of the letter.
F) The ending of the letter.
G) The signature

* **Sample cover letter**



9.3 Job Interview

9.3.1 Preparation and Practice

Remember that the employers? Final decision will rely heavily on a face – to – face meeting. It is also good to know that you can simultaneously asses whether the organization is suitable for you since interview is a moment of two way communication. Therefore, if you

prepare and practice in line with the following, you will undoubtedly conduct a successful job interview.

Preparation (There is no substitute for it)

A.1 Information

Gather information about the company, its background, its products, its philosophy and exactly what it does. (Visit the company's website and library, and is possible communicate the insiders).

A.2 Questions

Questions in the interview are to weave your answers around these three important qualifications:

1. Can the person do the work? (Qualifications)
2. Will the person do the work? (Motivation)
3. Will the person fit in team work? (Team work)

So, think of them in your preparation.

A.3 Personal appearance

- The moment needs special caution about personal hygiene and clothing. If hair is dirty, clothes unkempt and shoes soiled, It won't be difficult to imagine what the interviewers might speculate about the individual.

A.4 Timing

Arrive at the interview site early. It prevents anxiety and reduces pre – interview nerves.

B. Moment of Interview

B: 1 First impression

First impressions take only thirty seconds. What you look like, how you look the interviewer, even the way you sit can all play a crucial role. Perhaps direct and sustaining eye contact, a firm hand shake, sitting up straight and introducing yourself in confident way are important.

B.2 Smile and gesture

Relax, smile and use some hand gestures while answering questions. They suggest confidence and enthusiasm in the

B.3 Listening

Allow the interviewer to begin and lead the interview. Listen the question carefully.

B.4 Giving answer

Be sure that you understand the question before you try to answer. If you are not clear, you mustn't afraid to think for some time or to ask the interviewer to clarify it.

- Speak clearly and slowly. Give brief answers. Use good grammar. Avoid rambling. Don't get frustrated if you have an accent. It is not a bad thing as it is part of who you are.

B.5 Badmouth

You might be obliged to mention about your previous employers or staff. If so, no matter you may have disliked them, never say anything negative about (bad mouth) them. Focus only on the good experience that you had. This makes you lose nothing in return.

A.5 Truthfulness

You are responsible to be genuine in the interview. Anything you say about your self should truly demonstrate how your personality, skills and qualifications are a good fit for the job you are competing. Consider your weakness too, if any. Honestly keeps you confident.

A.6 Finding a common ground

Finding a common ground invites the interviewer to involve in the conversation actively and helps you form a positive bond. This leads the conversation to be sensational until ending.

A.7 Keep on

Sometimes, within minutes of the start, you will know that you don't wish to pursue the job. In such a situation, keep on performing the interview until ending rather than giving up. Accept that the practice is an advantage to you.

A.8 Keep in touch

Ask the interviewers at the end when they can inform you their decision. You might get valuable information from their

response. In addition, it lets them know that you are serious about the job and eager to work with them.

A.9 Acknowledgment

Before leaving don't forget to thank the interviews for taking the time to interview you. It shows good manner.

9.4 Acting Interview

An interview contains three acts: The entrance, the performance and the exit act.

9.4.1 Act one (Entrance)

Act one (Entrance) is the short moment when an interview gets into the interview room and meet with interviewers.

Example (Entrance)

Interviewer: Have a seat, please.
Candidate: Thank you, Sir/Madam.
Interviewer: Hello. Let's know your name.
Candidate: Hello. My name is Admassu.
Hurissa. Pleased to meet you.
Interviewer: Pleased to meet you too. Thank you for coming.
Candidate: Thank you for having me.
Interviewer: Would you like a cup of tea or something to drink before we get on with the interview?
Candidate: Thank you, a glass of water please.

9.4.2 Act two (performance)

It is the session at which the candidate is asked questions in order to find out if he/she is suitable for the job. The questions are about the interviewee's persona (the aspect of character or nature that he/she present to other people) and about experience (knowledge or skill). Hence, as an interviewee, quick understanding of the motive in questions is very important.

Commonly asked questions.

Q1. Tell us something about yourself.

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Name, address, marital status
  - Education
  - Experience
* **Useful tense**
  - Present simple: to express habits, routines, natural truths and time tabled future actions.
  - Present continuous: to express actions happening now and arrangements for the future.
  - Present perfect: to express the recent past, unfinished past and experiences.
  - Present perfect continuous: to express unfinished past and continuous actions that have just finished.
* **Sample response**

  My name is Roman Geletu. I was born here in Adama. I have graduated in public relations from Addis Ababa university. I am currently working for Ethiopian Red corss as a public relations officer. I have five years experiences in the field. In addition, I have led a local volunteer humanitarian association for three years in spare time. I am single.

Q2 Tell us something about your previous duties and responsibilities?

* **Suggested focus**
  - Work and experience related to the job you are competing for
* **Useful tense**
  - → Present simple
  - → Present perfect
  - → Past simple

- Actions and events that started and finished in the past.
- Actions one after another (when we are telling a story.)
- Routines and repeated actions finished in the past.

- **Sample response**

I have joined a government mining company since my graduation and led the safety department for two years. I was in charge of preparing training manuals and organizing frequent trainings for the company's workers. I have done fruitful jobs exerting unlimited effort to exist good team spirit among my colleagues. Then, I got a scholarship and left for china where I studied Msc. I made a thesis on the safety of mining Engineering. It has delivered me further expertise on the field.

Q3 What do you know about our company?

- **Suggested focus**
  - The company's back ground
  - Exactly what it does
- **Useful tense and comparison**
  - Present simple
  - Present continuous
  - Present perfect
  - Comparison (comparative and superlative degrees)
- **Sample response**

I know it is very young but that has become the largest beer manufacturer and exporter in the country. It is getting many employees' choice for its attractive working atmosphere. I have also known that the opportunity for career development is very high. In addition its remarkable support providing for the

local community development is really appreciable.

Q4 How do you handle jobs under pressure and stress?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Reaction to the situation rather than to the stress.
  - Working better under pressure.
  - Pressure invigorates.
  - Tight deadline and very stressful situation never be a threat to do best.
  - Stay calm under pressure and handle stress easily.
  - Physical exercise as a stress reducer.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present perfect
* **Sample response**

  Actually, I have never considered stressful situations as threat rather I see them as challenges to enrich skills and strength. From my experience, I often forget the stress and react to the situation instead. So, I have found dealing such way is the situation handled and doesn't become stressful. I have also found physical exercise to loosen up stress.

Q5 Tell us about a time when you received negative feedback from you manager. How did you handle it?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Handle criticism and rejection
  - Maintain enthusiasm
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Past simple
  - Past continuous: For activities continuing at a particular time in the past.

- For activities continuing when an action in the past happned.

* **Sample response**

I was a public relations officer for an organization. My department was in charge of publicizing activities. So, I used to edit a newspaper. One day, I was in my office when the boss phoned. He was angry about the article I had submitted to him for approval. He had assumed the story was false.

I immediately understood that he didn't hear of the incident I wrote about. But, I had to wait patiently for his hasty criticism to finish. Then, with a help of facts and evidences that I had, I could convince him the article was correct. The boss later apologized, saying he had been misinformed by somebody.

Q6 How would you describe yourself in terms of your ability to work as a member of a team?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Awareness about team work.
  - Teamwork skill and experience.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present perfect
  - Past simple
* **Sample response**

I have started developing better understanding of teamwork since I joined the HIV club at school. Everyone was working different tasks to achieve a particular interest of the club. I was convinced the larger project is accomplished only when the pieces of works are done. The moment also improved my ability to maintain good communication with people around. Good communication allowed

to exist team spirit among us and made us want our club to do well.

Q7 How do you evaluate success? Give us your most successful accomplishments.

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Sense of your values
  - How important you are for the organization.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present perfect
  - Past simple
* **Sample response**

I was hired by the revenue authority ten years ago. My jobs and responsibilities needed mainly the knowledge of the country's tax system often expected to be acquired through long time experience. But, I didn't choose to let the efficiency for the time. Rather I determined to read related materials intensively and attain competence within short period of time. Also, I maintained contacts with veteran colleagues. These helped me a great deal to achieve my intension quickly. I became able to carry out my duties independently in few weeks. Later, I could edit an excellent handbook for customers use. It is still being printed and circulated. This is a success for me.

Q8 How would you evaluate your ability to deal with conflict?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Conflicts could happen
  - Techniques of conflict resolution
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple

- Present perfect
- Past simple

* **Sample response**

I understand conflict is serious disagreement and argument about something important. So, often care about the importance and legality of my role in the conflict. Because, I think they are useful grounds to deal with it.

Q 9 What makes you angry?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Personality and emotional state.
  - State that you fit in
* **Useful tense**
  - Present simple
  - Present conditional (uses to express realistic, likely or probable events)

* **Sample response**

I proved myself even – tempered and confident. I know nothing could affect my temper.

If any upset happens, I want to know about it early. Then, I continue to discover why. If there's no good reason, I will go for an appropriate step. I could see this contributes a great deal to success. My unchanging calmness and way of handling impress both the management and workers.

Q 10 Tell us about something you did or failed to do that you know a little ashamed of.

* **Good to know**
  - The question is not about private life.
  - It is on the chance you admit to something, but if not, at least they will see how you think on your feet.
  - Never confess or regret as with faults and weaknesses.

- Say you harbor no regrets.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Past simple
  - Past continuous
  - Present simple
  - Present conditional

* **Sample response**

I really can't think of anything I did or failed to do that I now regret about. You know, I often emphasize to act on preventive measures. Like I said I have found that the best way to avoid regrets is to avoid causing them in the first place. Perhaps this habit has kept me from any regret.

Q 11 Tell us about the most boring job you have even had?

* **Good to know**
  - Enjoy working hard.
  - Never allow yourself to grow bored with a job.

* **Suggested tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present perfect
  - Present conditional

* **Sample response**

Personally I accept working hard is fun and interesting as it paves the way for satisfaction. It is the result of a sense of autonomy, purpose and the desire. So, I have never allowed myself to grow bored with any job. For that matter I couldn't understand it when others let themselves fall into it.

Q 12 What are your career goals?/Where do you see yourself five years from now?

* **Good to know**
  - Connect you response to the position and the company for which you are interviewing.
  - Irrelevant things like to study PhD or get marry might knock you out of the contest.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Conditional forms
  - Future simple
  - To indicate a simple prediction or strong probably
  - To describe things that have already been decided or inevitable
  - For programmed future events
  - Present continuous
* **Sample response**

Within the coming five years, I want to see myself becoming one of the top performers, handling much more duties and responsibilities in your company. To that effect, I intend to work hard, boost my expertise and introduce new ideas towards the achievement of the company's target. I also want to exert strong effort on the smooth communications and team – spirit that you have in your company can be sustained.

Q 13 Who is your current employer?/Why are you leaving your current job?

* **Good to know**
  - The question is to evaluate your current ability to work with them. As well as to discover any alarming traits you may have.
  - Be truthful, but if you feel your response might be understand negatively you must

emphasize how can you turn this
strength, or at least make sure it doesn't
affect your work with the new company

* **Useful tenses**
  - Present continuous
  - Present perfect
  - Present perfect continuous

* **Sample response**

Right now I am unemployed. I worked for the Revenue Authority for eleven years until by myself resigned two years ago. As in my resume, it has been the best moment of success and career development in my employment life. But I resigned because I felt that it was the right time to work for my passion, and decided to be a full time, writer until I get job which satisfy it. And now, the position you have here is exactly what I love to do and I am best at. I will be happy doing this work and that's what matters to me a lot more than money or title.

Q 14 Why do you want this job?

* **Good to know**
  - The question targets to test whether you have done any homework about the firm. If you have, you win big.
  - It is another opportunity to sell your skills and talents.
  - Be honest and sincere.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Future simple
  - Conditional tenses

* **Sample response**

I think it would be a great privilege to join a prestigious company such as yours. I decided to submit my resume as soon as I saw the job

posting. My years of experience enriched with intensive enrolment in the field exactly suit the duties states for the post. Moreover, I believe your company's excellent working environment permits to further my expertise.

Q 15 Why should we hire you?

Good to know:

- It is to hear why your skills and experiences make you the best fit for the job.
- Compare your abilities and experiences with the job description.
- Be positive and reiterate your interest in the company.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Conditional tenses
  - Present simple and perfect
* **Sample answers**

I'm confident my studies and experiences in the profession convince you to offer me the position. I have been working for an export company since my graduation. The company was last year honored with voluntary tax payer prize for professionalism in its finance system. As a result, I have won the best auditor award in the company. If I'm hired I'm sure you will have my proven efficiency in its better level, than any auditor can provide.

Q16 What are your hobbies/interests?/What do you do in your free time?

* **Good to know**
  - The question is to know if you have too heavy extracurricular load that can interfere with work duties.
  - Care not to impact the company's culture with your favorite outside activities.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
* **Sample response**

I enjoy watching football matches. The players striving and team techniques create feelings of excitement and

happiness on me. I am also interested in attending organized discussion about community issues. It gives me an opportunity to understand different thoughts and to make new friends as well.

Q 17 What are you greatest weaknesses?

* **Good to know**
  - Turn a negative into a positive or disguise strength as a weakness.
  - Assure that there is nothing that would stand in the way of your performing in this position with excellence.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present continues
  - Present perfect
  - Past simple
* **Sample response**

  I feel a little nervous and uncomfortable to start speaking in public, for the first few seconds in particular. I always fight shy of fearing to begin a presentation or any public speech. I am used to rehearsing before I go on stage for any presentation. So, I have found repeated exercise is improving the feeling, and hope eventually avoidable.

Q 18 What is your greatest strength?

* **Good to know**
  - The question is to learn about your personal qualities. Mention the greatest strength chosen by yourself from your most recent and impressive achievements.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
* **Sample response**

  I often bring useful ways how things might be improved or succeeded. I also have strong desire to achieve my goals successfully. People admire my punctuality and

open – mindedness. I am a good communicator and initiator. But I'd say my greatest strength is proactivness.

Q 19 To what extent would you be willing to travel for the job?

* **Good to know**
  - The question is to know how you are flexible for the work and if you are willing to put in the effort, and also how serious you take the job.
  - Give your answer to the expectations of the interviewer as well as your reality.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
* **Sample response**

Well, I believe travel on a job assignment can't depend on my willing so long as it is necessary for it. I know every job asks some kind of commitments. So, if necessary, I won't have any boundary. By the way, I really enjoy travel. It relaxes me, and also gives me an opportunity for a change.

Q 20 Describe what you do to control mistakes in your work.

* **Good to know:**
  - The question is to know if you are able to accurately complete your tasks with close attention to all aspects of your work and a careful control of errors.
  - Mention your concern with maintaining accuracy and checking your works for efforts regularly.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Past simple
  - Conditional tenses
* **Sample response**

Few weeks ago, I had to coordinate an event planned to improve tax payers awareness on the use of cash register machine. I shared the tasks with my team members and set daily meeting in the end of every working hours until the event carried out. We met every day and dealt with

daily action. We found easier to bring solutions for the challenges we faced amid works. The daily meetings helped me a great deal to monitor the progress and update my boss on the feedbacks. In this way we were able to organize a fruitful event in which thousands attended.

Q 21 Have you ever recommend a new idea or suggestion to your supervisor or manager?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Tell that you are proactive, innovative and self starter. Raise your suggestion that was agreed and implemented recently.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present perfect
  - Past simple

Q 22 Have you ever had a time that your were not satisfied with your performance? What did you do?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - To know if you set high standard for your self and strive to meet them.
  - Your efforts and techniques to correct below standard performances.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Past simple
  - Past continuous

Q23 What do you like least about your last job?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Tell there was nothing you hated.
  - You can mention about you liked least.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Past simple
  - Past continuous

Q24 What do you think of your previous boss?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Mention what you learned from him
  - Don't badmouth him
  - State his strength

* **Useful tenses**
  - Past simple

Q 25 Give us an example of your creativity.

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Mention what and when you were creative, analytical etc
  - Better to tell your greatest and most recent achievement
* **Useful tenses**
  - Past simple

Q 26 Which is more important to you; the job or your salary?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - You mustn't say salary is your main motivation.
  - Prefer that more jobs, responsible and challenges motivates you.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present continuous

Q 27 What are your salary requirements?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Express that you are sure they will offer you fair and commensurately modest with the value you can bring to the company.
  - You shouldn't start salary negotiations talking about the pay.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present conditional
  - Future simple

Q 28 The inappropriate question

* Good to know
  These type of questions may include very private things might result in any form of discrimination. For example they might be about your spouse, religion, ethnic origin etc.
* Suggested ways to handle inappropriate questions

- Swallow your concerns over privacy and answer them straight forwardly.
- If you don't like to allow your privacy invaded, you can answer the concern behind the question without answering the question itself.

Q 29 The Hypothetical problem

* **Good to know**
  - These types of questions are about how you handle difficult situations. They are "what would you do?" questions.
* **Suggested focuses**
  - Describe your process or working methods.
  - Don't fall into the trap of trying to solve this problem and giving your verdict on the spot.
  - When you describe the rational, methodical process you would follow analyzing would consult with, generating possible solutions, choosing the best course of action, and monitoring the results.

Q 30 What's the most difficult part of being a _____?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - When you identify any part as "difficult" your interviewer could include the part as where you are weak. So first, redefine it to be "challenging".
  - Identify an area everyone in your profession consider challenging and in which you excel.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present conditional

Q31 Describe the characteristics of successful manager

Suggested focuses

You are evaluated how aware of characteristics and responsibilities of a successful manager you are.

- A successful manager could be able to have the vision and capabilities to formulate strategies to reach his/her targets and communicate the ideas to his co-workers. He/she is a role model.
- He/she is capable to inspire others to recognize to their utmost potential to reach a common goal.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple

Q 32 Aren't you over qualified for this position?

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Know that this question mainly arises from the interviewers worry that you may leave as soon as something better comes your way.
  - Demonstrate sincerity of your commitment and reassure them that you are looking to stay for the long term.
  - Don't think of it as a sign of imminent defeat. Rather understand it as an invitation to teach the interviewer a new way to think about it, seeing advantages instead of drawbacks.
  - Tell that the position you are contending is exactly what you love and you are best at.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Present perfect
  - Future continuous
  - Conditional tense

Q 33 The silent Treatment

Good to know

- The question is to put you under stress and see how you respond.
- It is done after you answer a certain question. The interviewers just stare at you in a deafening silence instead of asking another. They sit silent as if they do not believe what you have just said, or making you feel you have violated rule of interview ethics.
- If this happens to you, keep quiet for a while and ask politely, "Is there anything else I can fill in on that point?" With care not a trace of sarcasm.

Q 34 Why have you been out of work so long?

* **Good to know**
  - Better not to emphasize factors that have prolonged your job search by your own choice.
* **Suggested focuses**
  - Tell that you decided to take whatever time thinking of want to do, like to go and identifying those organizations that could offer such as opportunity.
  - Mention that you made wise decision not to jump on the first opportunity to come along.
* **Useful tenses**
  - Present conditional
  - Present perfect
  - Past simple

Q35 The Fatal Flow questions

* **Good to know**
  - It is a bad question as nothing production can come from it.
  - The question arises from your resume. Interviewers may try to zero in on a "Fatal Flaw" of your candidacy, perhaps that you

don't have a degree, you have been out of the job market, etc.

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Admit your short comings honestly, and tell that they are describable.
  - Do not apologize or try to explain it away.
  - Tell that your short coming hasn't prevented you from compiling outstanding achievements.
  - Give examples of how through relentless commitment you have outperformed who do have this qualification.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Present simple
  - Conditional tenses

Q 36 Questions on confidential matters

* **Good to know**
  - The question is for testing your integrity.
  - Respect the rights of those who have trusted you with their most sensitive information

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Never reveal anything truly confidential about a present or former employer.
  - Explain your reticence diplomatically.
  - You can raise how you made the company safe by harboring its confidential matter.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Future simple
  - Conditional tenses

Q 37 What changes would you make if you came on board?

* **Good to know**
  - You cannot know the right actions before you get to know the company's

operations, its strengths and weaknesses, its key people, financial conditions, etc.

* **Suggested focuses**
  - Tell that you will want to take a good hard look at everything the company is doing before making any recommendations.

* **Useful tenses**
  - Conditional tenses
  - Future simple

9.4.3 Act 3 (The exist)

A) You thank and leave in the exit act. Interviewers often ask a type of questions imply the transition to the exit act or the ending of the interview.

* **Sample questions**
  - **Interviewers**
    - Do you have any questions for us?
    - Is there anything you'd like to know about us?

Candidate's response:

- How would you describe the company's management style?
- Is this a new position?
- What would my duties include?
- Is travel expected in this position?
- What are the prospects for growth and advancement.

B) At the end

* Don't forget to thank you interviewers for their time.
* Ask for the next steps, and when you can expect a response from them.
* **Sample ending**

  I would like to thank you for having given me the opportunity and your time. I have found the interview a substantial addition to my experience.

  When do you expect you will notify me to start the employment formalities?

Sample interview

Interviewer: Come in please.

Candidate: Thank you, good morning.

Interviewer: Good morning, sit down.

Candidate: Thank you

Interviewer: Let's begin with your personal details.

Candidate: My name is Yonas Abera. I was born in Bonga in 1988 E.C. I've graduated in management from Arbaminch university. I was a voluntary assistant manager for a humanitarian association for the last one year. By now I am in between jobs. I am single.

Interviewer: Why you left the association.

Candidate: When I was a university student, I promised to give any such an association voluntary service for one year. I really like to help people. But, I left the association as I had to keep my promise.

Interviewer: Describe the characteristics of a good manager.

Candidate: Well, I think he should have a clear vision. He ought to be reliable, honest, time conscious and result oriented.

Interviewer: How can you handle a difficult person?

Candidate: I must be tolerant, and try to influence him positively. I believe I am very good at working with any kind of person.

Interviewer: Do you have any question we can answer for you?

Candidate: Is this a new position?

Interviewer: Yes, it emerges from our expansion plan.

Candidate: thank you very much for having given me the opportunity as well as for your time. I have found the interview a substantial addition to my experience. When do you expect you will notify me to start the employment formalities?

Made by Samuel Tafere
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